Telecom Customer Support and FAQ Knowledge Base

Version 3.2 | Internal reference for support agents and the AI assistant

About this document. This is a synthetic knowledge base created for learning and testing Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) pipelines. All numbers, plan names and policies are fictional. It is not the original PDF from any course.

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Section 1: Billing and Account Management

1.1 How do I check my current account balance?

- Dial ***123#** from your phone for an instant USSD balance display.
- Log in to the My Telecom app (iOS and Android) and open the Home tab.
- Send an SMS with the keyword BALANCE to 150. A reply arrives within 30 seconds.

1.2 What payment methods are accepted for postpaid bills?

- Credit and debit cards (Visa, MasterCard, RuPay), UPI, Net Banking and auto-debit through a registered bank mandate.
- Cash is accepted at any authorized Telecom Experience Center. Cash payments above Rs. 10,000 per bill are not accepted.
- Payments made through the app reflect within 5 minutes. Cash and cheque payments may take up to 2 working days.

1.3 How can I download past invoices?

- Invoices for the last 12 billing cycles are available in the app under Billing History and on the self-care web portal.
- A PDF copy can also be emailed to your registered address using the Send Invoice option.

1.4 I was charged more than expected. What should I check?

- Open the itemised bill and check for out-of-bundle usage, premium SMS, roaming and value-added services (VAS).
- Check for one-time charges such as SIM replacement or plan change fees.
- If the charge is still unclear, raise a billing dispute within 30 days of the invoice date (see Section 8).

1.5 Billing cycle and late fees

Postpaid bills are generated on the 1st of every month with a due date 15 days later. A late fee of 2 percent of the outstanding amount (minimum Rs. 50) applies after the due date.

Outgoing services are restricted 10 days after the due date. Services are restored within 2 hours of full payment.

Billing term	Meaning
Billing cycle	Monthly period for which usage is billed
Due date	Last date to pay without a late fee
Out-of-bundle	Usage beyond the plan's included benefits
VAS	Value-added services such as caller tunes

Section 2: Plans, Recharges and Validity

2.1 What prepaid plan categories are available?

- Unlimited plans: daily data quota, unlimited calls and 100 SMS per day, with validity of 28, 56, 84 or 365 days.
- Data booster packs: add-on data valid for 1 to 30 days, no calls or SMS included.
- Talktime top-ups: add balance for pay-per-use calling at 40 paise per minute.

Plan	Price	Validity	Daily data	Extras
Basic 199	Rs. 199	28 days	1 GB	Unlimited calls
Plus 299	Rs. 299	28 days	2 GB	Unlimited calls, OTT bundle
Value 719	Rs. 719	84 days	1.5 GB	Unlimited calls
Annual 2999	Rs. 2,999	365 days	2 GB	Unlimited calls, 5G access

2.2 What happens when my daily data is used up?

- Speed is reduced to 64 kbps until midnight. Unused daily data does not carry over to the next day.

2.3 How do I recharge?

- Use the app, the website, UPI apps or any authorized retailer. Recharge is instant in most cases.
- If you were charged but the recharge failed, the amount is refunded to the source account within 3 to 5 working days.

2.4 What if my plan expires?

- There is a 7-day grace period in which incoming calls and SMS continue. After the grace period, the number may be deactivated after 30 days of inactivity.
- To keep a number active with minimal spend, recharge with the cheapest validity pack at least once every 90 days.

2.5 Can I change my plan midway?

- Prepaid: a new plan queues after the current plan ends unless you choose Activate Now, which replaces the current plan without a refund.
- Postpaid: plan changes take effect from the next billing cycle. One free change is allowed per cycle.

Section 3: Mobile Internet Troubleshooting

3.1 Why is my mobile internet slow?

- Check whether the daily high-speed data quota is exhausted. If so, speeds drop to 64 kbps until midnight or until a booster pack is activated.
- Toggle Airplane mode on and off to reconnect to the nearest cell tower.
- Restart the phone to clear stuck network sockets.
- Make sure APN settings match the defaults: **telecom.web**.
- Check the network mode. Select 4G/5G (auto) rather than 3G only.
- Move to an open area. Basements, lifts and thick-walled buildings weaken signal.

3.2 How do I configure APN settings manually?

- Android: Settings > Network and Internet > Mobile Network > Access Point Names > Add. Name: Telecom, APN: telecom.web, APN type: default,supl.
- iOS: Settings > Cellular > Cellular Data Network > enter telecom.web in the APN field.

3.3 Mobile data is on but nothing loads

- Confirm that data balance remains and that the plan has not expired.
- Disable any VPN or data saver. Turn off Wi-Fi to test.
- Reset network settings (this removes saved Wi-Fi passwords) as a last resort.
- If the problem persists on multiple devices with the same SIM, log a ticket with category Data Not Working.

3.4 How do I enable 5G?

- 5G is available on the Annual 2999 plan and on postpaid plans above Rs. 499.
- The phone must support the 5G bands used in your city. Set preferred network type to 5G/4G/3G (auto).
- 5G coverage can be checked on the coverage map in the app.

3.5 Typical speed expectations

4G: 10 to 40 Mbps in good coverage. 5G: 100 to 400 Mbps depending on the location and load. Speeds vary with time of day, tower congestion and device.

Section 4: Calls, SMS and Network Coverage Issues

4.1 I cannot make or receive calls

- Check for the network name and signal bars. If it shows Emergency calls only, reinsert the SIM and restart.
- Confirm the plan is active and that Do Not Disturb or call barring is not enabled. Dial ##002# to cancel all call forwarding.
- Check the phone's SIM manager to verify that the correct SIM is the default for calls.

4.2 Calls drop frequently

- Enable Wi-Fi Calling (VoWiFi) where supported. This is helpful indoors.
- Enable VoLTE in the phone's mobile network settings. Update the phone software.
- If drops happen only at a specific location, report the exact address and time so that engineers can check the tower.

4.3 I am not receiving OTP messages

- Check that the DND (Do Not Disturb) category does not block transactional messages. Send START 0 to 1909 to allow all messages.
- Check that SMS storage is not full and that the sender is not blocked.
- OTPs may be delayed up to 2 minutes during peak load. Request again only after waiting 2 minutes.

4.4 How do I report poor network coverage?

- Use Report Network Issue in the app, or call 198. Provide the location, time, and nature of the problem (no signal, slow data, call drops).
- Network tickets are acknowledged immediately and typically investigated within 72 hours.

Symptom	First action	If unresolved
No signal	Restart, reinsert SIM	Visit service center
Calls drop	Enable VoLTE / VoWiFi	Report tower issue
No OTP	Send START 0 to 1909	Raise SMS ticket
Data slow	Check quota, APN	Raise data ticket

Section 5: Security, SIM Swap and Fraud Prevention

5.1 What is a SIM swap attack and how do I prevent it?

A SIM swap attack happens when a fraudster convinces the carrier to move your phone number to a SIM card they control. They then receive your SMS OTPs and can access bank and email accounts.

Steps to prevent it:

- Enable SIM Lock (PIN) in your phone settings so that the SIM cannot be used in another device without the PIN.
- Register a secondary recovery email and set up multi-factor remote verification with security questions at the carrier support desk.
- Never share OTPs or account PINs over calls, SMS or chat.
- If your phone suddenly loses network for an extended period in a good coverage area, contact support immediately. This can mean an unauthorized SIM replacement.

5.2 How does the carrier verify SIM replacement requests?

- Replacement requires a valid government ID, a one-time password sent to the registered alternate contact, and in-person biometric verification at an authorized center.
- After a replacement, outgoing SMS and data are restricted for 24 hours as a fraud-control measure.

5.3 Common fraud types and warning signs

- Vishing: callers pretending to be bank or carrier staff and asking for OTPs or KYC details.
- Smishing: SMS links claiming that your SIM will be blocked unless you click. The carrier never sends such links.
- Fake customer care numbers listed on search engines. Use only the number in the app or on the official website.
- SIM cloning and unauthorized port-out requests.

5.4 What to do if you suspect fraud

- Call 198 and request an immediate account lock. Change passwords for banking and email accounts.
- Report the incident on the national cybercrime portal and keep screenshots and call logs.

Section 6: Lost, Stolen and Replacement SIMs; Number Porting

6.1 What should I do if my phone is lost or stolen?

- Immediately call 198 from another number to temporarily block the SIM.
- File a police report and keep a copy of the FIR for insurance.
- Visit the nearest Telecom Experience Center with a valid government ID to get a replacement SIM with the same number.
- Block the device using its IMEI through the national device registry portal.

6.2 How long does SIM replacement take?

- Same-day activation in most cases. Replacement SIM fee is Rs. 100. The new SIM becomes active within 2 hours; the old SIM stops working at that point.

6.3 How do I port my number to another carrier?

- Send PORT followed by your mobile number to 1900 to receive a Unique Porting Code (UPC), valid for 4 days.
- Submit the UPC to the new carrier along with identity documents.
- Porting normally completes in 3 working days. Service continues until the switch window.

6.4 When is porting not allowed?

- Postpaid accounts with unpaid dues.
- Numbers less than 90 days since activation or last porting.
- Numbers with an active legal or fraud investigation.

6.5 Changing the registered name or KYC

- Visit a service center with the original ID. Change of ownership requires the consent of both parties and takes 3 to 5 working days.

Section 7: International Roaming

7.1 How do I activate international roaming?

- Activate from the app under Services > International Roaming at least 24 hours before travel.
- Prepaid users need a minimum balance of Rs. 500. Postpaid users must have no overdue bills.

Pack	Price	Validity	Includes
Roam 1	Rs. 799	1 day	1 GB, 100 min, 100 SMS
Roam 7	Rs. 2,999	7 days	5 GB, 300 min, 100 SMS
Roam 30	Rs. 5,999	30 days	15 GB, 500 min, 300 SMS

7.2 What charges apply without a pack?

- Out-of-pack roaming is charged at pay-per-use rates: data Rs. 5 per MB, outgoing calls Rs. 80 per minute and incoming calls Rs. 40 per minute. It is strongly advised to buy a pack before travelling.

7.3 I have no internet while roaming

- Enable Data Roaming in phone settings and select a partner network manually if automatic selection fails.
- Confirm that the roaming pack is active and has data remaining. Restart the phone after landing.

7.4 How do I avoid bill shock?

- Turn off background data and app auto-updates. Set a data usage warning limit on the phone.
- Use hotel Wi-Fi for large downloads. Check roaming usage in the app, which updates every few hours.

Section 8: Complaints, Escalation and Service Levels

8.1 How do I raise a complaint?

- Use the app (Help > Raise Ticket), call 198, or visit an Experience Center. Every complaint receives a ticket number by SMS.
- Keep the ticket number for all follow-ups.

Level	Channel	Resolution time
L1	App / helpline 198	24 to 48 hours
L2	Nodal officer (email)	7 working days
L3	Appellate authority	30 days
External	Telecom regulator portal	As per regulator

8.2 Service level targets

- Billing disputes: resolved within 7 working days. Refunds: 5 to 7 working days after approval.
- Network faults: acknowledged immediately and fixed within 72 hours for non-critical issues.
- SIM activation: 2 hours. Porting: 3 working days.

8.3 When should I escalate?

- If a ticket is unresolved after the stated time, or is closed without resolution, escalate to L2 and quote the ticket number.
- Escalate immediately for suspected fraud, unauthorized SIM replacement or total loss of service for more than 24 hours.

8.4 Contact summary

- Helpline: 198 (free from any Telecom number). Balance: *123#. Porting: 1900. DND: 1909.
- Hours: the helpline operates 24 hours a day. Experience Centers are open from 10 AM to 7 PM, Monday to Saturday.